ALLY WEALTH • AUTHOR VISIBILITY CONSULTANT

Book Series Marketing Guide

Position a connected catalogue so readers can understand where to begin and what comes next.

A practical workbook and reference guide

EDUCATIONAL RESOURCE • 2026 EDITION

How to use this guide

Series marketing is about helping readers understand the relationship between books and making the next step clear. It does not require every title to have identical messaging. This guide covers series architecture, reading order, metadata consistency, launch coordination and reader pathways.

Work through the pages in order. Use the prompts to make decisions, record assumptions and identify actions. You can revisit a page when your book, audience or publishing plan changes.

Keep the work evidence-aware. Platform interfaces, policies and marketplace features change. Verify current official guidance before acting on platform-specific instructions. Treat examples as planning aids, not guarantees.

Make it your own. Not every tactic belongs in every campaign. Choose the actions that fit your book, resources, readers and values.

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01 / FIELD GUIDE

Define the series promise

Describe the experience or subject thread that connects the books. Identify what readers can expect to remain consistent and what changes from volume to volume.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **define the series promise**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

• What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?

• What is the smallest useful next step, who owns it, and when will it be reviewed?

Working notes

02 / FIELD GUIDE

Map the series structure

List every title, format, publication status and relationship. Mark prequels, companion books, spin-offs and connected standalones so the structure is clear internally.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **map the series structure**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

03 / FIELD GUIDE

Choose a reading order

Decide whether publication order, chronological order or a recommended entry point best serves readers. Explain the choice wherever readers are likely to encounter the series.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **choose a reading order**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Clarify each book’s role

Give every volume a distinct purpose, conflict or reader benefit. A series should feel connected without making each description sound interchangeable.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **clarify each book’s role**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Create a consistent visual system

Use recognisable design elements across covers while preserving clear differences between volumes. Check thumbnails, spine treatment and format variations.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **create a consistent visual system**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Align titles and subtitles

Review naming patterns for clarity and searchability. Avoid confusing numbering, inconsistent subtitles or changes that make older editions difficult to recognise.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **align titles and subtitles**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Build a series overview

Create a concise overview for the website or retailer page where supported. Explain the premise, reading order and ideal reader without revealing major spoilers.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **build a series overview**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Optimise individual descriptions

Each description should make sense on its own while signalling the series connection. Include the volume number or relationship where appropriate and accurate.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **optimise individual descriptions**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Review metadata consistency

Check author name, series name, volume number, categories, keywords, edition data and publication details across the catalogue. Verify current platform rules before editing.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **review metadata consistency**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Connect formats and editions

Make sure ebook, print, hardcover and audio details are accurate and that readers can identify the edition they want. Do not assume all platforms link formats in the same way.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **connect formats and editions**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Plan the first-book entry point

Decide how a new reader can begin. Make the first book’s promise and availability easy to understand, and avoid sending newcomers directly to a later volume without explanation.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **plan the first-book entry point**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Support the next-book decision

At the end of each book, where appropriate, provide a clear and accurate pointer to the next volume. Respect reader choice and platform formatting requirements.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **support the next-book decision**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Coordinate a sequel launch

Prepare the previous-book pathway before the sequel arrives. Check whether descriptions, series data and links help readers understand the sequence.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **coordinate a sequel launch**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Use backlist momentum thoughtfully

A new release can renew attention to earlier titles, but the connection should be relevant. Prepare updated series information and useful reading-order content.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **use backlist momentum thoughtfully**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Plan series-wide campaigns

Choose a theme or reader question that connects multiple books. Ensure each promoted title has a clear role and the campaign does not overwhelm readers with catalogue-wide sales copy.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **plan series-wide campaigns**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Create a series asset kit

Prepare a complete cover set, book summaries, series overview, reading order, author bio and approved visuals. Keep the kit updated as new books are added.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **create a series asset kit**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Explain entry points for new readers

If a series has a complex chronology, offer a simple guide. Use plain language and examples rather than assuming readers understand internal publishing terminology.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **explain entry points for new readers**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Use reader feedback

Look for repeated confusion about order, character relationships or continuity. Clarify the presentation without revealing private reader information.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **use reader feedback**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Coordinate ARC outreach across volumes

For a new instalment, make clear whether prior books are needed and what the ARC recipient is being asked to read. Keep review invitations voluntary and independent.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **coordinate arc outreach across volumes**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Manage spoilers

Label content that discusses later volumes. Avoid using major revelations from earlier books in later promotional material unless readers are warned.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **manage spoilers**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Plan series pricing carefully

Consider the reader experience, production costs, format and territory. Pricing decisions should be evaluated as business choices, not guaranteed ranking tactics.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **plan series pricing carefully**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

- Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?
- What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?
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Working notes

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Consider bundles and box sets

If offering a bundle, confirm rights, file quality, pricing, retailer requirements and the value to readers. Make contents and reading order explicit.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **consider bundles and box sets**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Coordinate audio and other formats

Keep narration, cover identity, series names and descriptions coherent across formats. Explain release timing accurately when formats are not simultaneous.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **coordinate audio and other formats**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

• What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?

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Working notes

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Build a series landing page

Provide a clear series introduction, book cards, reading order, format links and relevant author information. Make the page mobile-friendly and accessible.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **build a series landing page**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Use content to deepen the series world

Share research, themes, setting notes or subject context that enriches interest without requiring readers to consume every post.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **use content to deepen the series world**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Track series read-through signals

Where data is available, review movement between volumes, format choices and reader questions. Interpret data cautiously and account for different reporting systems.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **track series read-through signals**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

• What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?

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Working notes

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Audit the reader journey

Test the path from a social post or search result to book one, then to the next volume. Remove broken links and unclear instructions.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **audit the reader journey**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Prepare for a new volume

Update series overview, reading order, catalogue assets, metadata and backmatter links. Confirm every claim and release detail before publishing.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **prepare for a new volume**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

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Working notes

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Keep continuity and brand flexible

Review whether the series still fulfils its promise as it grows. Make updates that help readers without rewriting history or obscuring earlier editions.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **keep continuity and brand flexible**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

• What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?

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Working notes

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Your series marketing blueprint

Summarise series promise, structure, order, individual book roles, visual system, reader pathway, campaign plan and next review date.

Put this into practice

Write down the current situation for **your series marketing blueprint**. What is already working? What is unclear? What evidence do you have, and what are you assuming? Identify one change that would make the experience clearer or more useful for the intended reader.

Decision questions

• Who is this action intended to help, and what would that person need to understand?

• What facts, permissions or platform rules must be checked before proceeding?

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Working notes